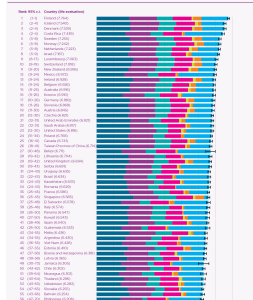


Redesigning the World Happiness Report ranking chart

STATS 401 Individual Project: Visualization Critique and Redesign

1. Original

Figure 2.1: Country rankings by life evaluations
Gallup World Poll (2023–2025)



World Happiness Report 2026, Fig. 2.1 (top 56 of 147 rows). Bar length = mean life evaluation (0–10); seven segments = six explanatory factors + “Dystopia + residual”.

2. Critique

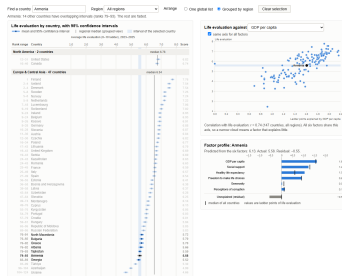
Strengths

- + Sorted bars on a common baseline: totals compare accurately (Cleveland & McGill, 1984).
- + Uncertainty is shown: 95% intervals for scores and ranks.

Weaknesses

- W1** Stacking implies the six factors add up to the score; the ranking actually uses survey answers only.
- W2** Only the first segment has a common baseline, so factors cannot be compared across countries.
- W3** 147 ranked rows overstate tiny gaps (neighbors differ by about 0.02; intervals are about 0.22 wide) and hide regions.

3. Redesign (D3.js, three linked views)



- W3** Dots with 95% intervals and rank ranges; selecting a country (here Armenia) fades clearly different ones.
- W1 W2** One factor per axis against the score, plus a common-baseline profile; residual shown on its own.
- W3** Grouped by region with median lines; filter and search; one hue instead of seven.